Movie Secrets From 'The Mandalorian and Grogu'

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Hal Hickel works at Industrial Light & Magic, or ILM, a company that makes movie **special effects**. On Thursday, at the View Conference in Turin, Italy, he shared secrets from "The Mandalorian and Grogu."

Hickel kept asking, "What would Phil do?" He meant Phil Tippett, an expert in **stop-motion**. In **stop-motion**, puppets are moved a tiny bit at a time and photographed frame by frame. Tippett worked on the first "Star Wars" movies.

The team made the giant AT-AT walkers move slowly to show how heavy they are. For a smaller walker, **animators** studied ostriches.

Rotta the Hutt is voiced by Jeremy Allen White. Director Jon Favreau felt the first design "didn't feel Hutt-y enough," so the team made Rotta look more like his father, Jabba. Rotta speaks English so younger viewers do not have to read lots of **subtitles**.

The movie even has a real **stop-motion** fight between two giant **droids**. Hickel moved a puppet himself!

Word Treasure

special effects -- Tricks and techniques used to make amazing things appear in movies.

stop-motion -- Animation made by moving puppets a little at a time and taking a picture each time.

animators -- Artists who make characters and objects move on screen.

subtitles -- Words shown at the bottom of the screen to show what characters say.

droids -- Robots in the Star Wars stories.

Background you need

Star Wars is a famous series of space adventure movies that began many years ago.

Movie effects can be made with computers or with real puppets, models and machines.

In stop-motion, many still photos are played quickly so puppets look like they are moving.

Break it down

WHO: Hal Hickel of Industrial Light & Magic
WHAT: He shared how the effects in 'The Mandalorian and Grogu' were made
WHERE: The View Conference in Turin, Italy
WHY: To show how old-style stop-motion and new effects were mixed in the movie

Why it matters

It shows kids that movie magic often comes from real puppets and hard work, not just computers.

Test what you remember

1. What company does Hal Hickel work for?

- (A) Tesla
- (B) Netflix
- (C) NASA
- (D) Industrial Light & Magic

2. Who is Phil Tippett?

- (A) A tennis player
- (B) A director of cartoons only
- (C) A singer
- (D) An expert in stop-motion

3. Which animal did animators study for a smaller walker?

- (A) Ostriches
- (B) Cats
- (C) Dolphins
- (D) Snakes

4. Who voices Rotta the Hutt?

- (A) Jon Favreau
- (B) Hal Hickel
- (C) Phil Tippett
- (D) Jeremy Allen White

5. Who is Rotta's father?

- (A) Jabba
- (B) Yoda
- (C) Grogu
- (D) Mando

6. Where did Hickel share these secrets?

- (A) Tokyo, Japan
- (B) Paris, France
- (C) Turin, Italy
- (D) New York

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: D 3: A 4: D 5: A 6: C

Questions to think about

1. Jon Favreau, director: Felt the first design of Rotta didn't feel Hutt-y enough.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):